

gemstone-js vs gemstone-py

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gemstone-js and gemstone-py now overlap heavily for core GemStone/S work, but they are aimed at different application runtimes.

Use gemstone-py when the application is Python-first and you want the most mature product surface today: sync and async Python APIs, broader examples, FastAPI/Litestar/Django coverage, the Python database explorer, VS Code workbench flow, and the deeper PyPI/TestPyPI/native wheel release lane.

Use gemstone-js when the application is TypeScript or JavaScript-first: Node services, npm-distributed tools, explicit async request lifecycles, typed generated wrappers, web adapters, and package verification in a JS toolchain.

For object mapping, the projects should intentionally differ. gemstone-py can lean on Python's dynamic proxy style, while gemstone-js should prefer a connector-inspired mapping manifest that generates explicit async `*Ref` classes, repository helpers, and snapshot/dictionary helpers around `TypedOop<T>`. The runtime now has two bridge layers: `mappedObject()` for method-shaped selector sends such as `booking.status()`, and `transparentObject()` for the closer Python-like shape, including `await booking.status`, callable selector accessors, queued assignment writes, optional per-proxy caching, and request-scoped identity reuse through `TransparentObjectMapper`. For exploratory tooling, `smalltalkBridge()` now closes more of gemstone-py's dynamic bridge gap with lazy global proxies, awaitable selector properties, underscore-to-colon keyword dispatch, exact `$send*()` controls, and retained-object handoff into transparent proxies.

Quick Commands

```
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --scorecard
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --view scorecard
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --gaps
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --batches
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --scope beta --view totals
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --scorecard --markdown
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --totals --json
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --view totals --json --assert-total-batches 6 --assert-hours-max
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --scope beta --view totals --json --assert-total-batches 1 --asse
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --view totals --max-total-batches 6 --max-hours-max 72 --quiet
gemstone-js-compare --target gemstone-js --scope beta --view totals --max-total-batches 1 --max-hours-max
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --scorecard --json --output comparison-report.json
gemstone-js-compare gemstone-js --scorecard --format markdown --output comparison-report.md
gemstone-js-compare all --totals
```

Every JSON report includes `$schema: "./schemas/comparison-report.schema.json"` and `schema_version: 1`. `--output <path>` writes either JSON or human-readable reports for release notes and CI artifacts. `--markdown` or `--format markdown` renders Markdown directly. `npm run compare:check` validates every comparison target/view pair, output-file writing, Markdown rendering, exact assertion flags, maximum-threshold flags, quiet CI checks, and the current full and beta batch totals.

Current State

gemstone-js is close to gemstone-py for core database work:

- sessions, explicit login/logout, and environment-based configuration
- raw OOP handling, retained typed handles, and export-set cleanup
- value conversion for strings, symbols, numbers, arrays, dictionaries, dates, class instances, and custom converters
- persistent roots, dictionaries, ordered collections, GStore, ObjectLog, and reduced-conflict wrappers
- query helpers, indexes, bounded pages, count/exists/first/limit helpers, and collection mutation helpers
- migrations, transaction retries, nested transactions, request scopes, pools, and web adapter lifecycles
- manifest/decorator TypeScript codegen, JSON Schemas, examples, benchmark reports, checksums, release artifact checks, and installed package probes
- bulk selector sends for raw OOPs, marshalled JS values, mixed calls, and object-returning retained handles
- opt-in transparent mapping through `transparentObject()` and dynamic Smalltalk-style global/selector dispatch through `smalltalkBridge()`
- a small dependency-free browser explorer for status, OOP inspection, roots/globals, workspace eval, class browsing, and codegen preview

`gemstone-py` remains ahead where project maturity matters:

- broader real application examples
- Python async and sync surfaces
- framework coverage, especially Django and larger Flask/webstack examples
- more mature visual explorer and VS Code workflows
- release history and native wheel confidence
- broader live GemStone test coverage across application shapes

Work Remaining

The comparison CLI reports **6 batches**, roughly **42-72 hours**, for fuller JS/Python product parity:

1. Native publish confidence
2. Visual tooling polish
3. Installed examples
4. Live CI
5. Documentation and release polish
6. Cross-project alignment

The most useful post-beta API polish batch is generated object mapping maturity: publish a mapping manifest schema, generate `*Ref` classes wrapping `TypedOop<T>` or delegating to `transparentObject()`, add repository helpers returning typed refs, generate bounded snapshots for UI/API payloads, and surface the mapping catalog in Explorer or the VS Code workbench.

For a narrower conservative JavaScript beta, `--scope beta` now tracks one remaining validation batch, roughly **4-8 hours**: run the release candidate from clean installed JS and native artifacts, verify worker-mode live smoke, and inspect release metadata before publishing.

Practical Recommendation

For production Python projects, start with `gemstone-py`.

For TypeScript services, npm packages, Node tooling, or codegen-heavy JS workflows, use `gemstone-js`, but validate native behavior against a real Stone before treating it as production-stable.

The VS Code extension should remain a later track. The JavaScript API and native session-thread behavior should settle first so editor workflows do not freeze unstable assumptions.

For the implementation-level parity ledger, see [docs/gemstone-py-parity.md](https://docs.gemstone-py-parity.md). For the Rust/Python ecosystem comparison, see [docs/gemstone-rs-comparison.md](https://docs.gemstone-rs-comparison.md).